1894

Mark Twain was the most famous writer in America. In 1894 he was **broke.**

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The bet: the Paige Compositor.

18,000

parts, roughly

Twain poured in about $300,000.

> The machine kept needing an operator to step in.

Meanwhile, a rival took the industry.

TWAIN'S BET

Paige Compositor: mimicked a human typesetter

THE WINNER

Mergenthaler's Linotype: cast fresh type

1894: his publishing firm failed.

$100K+

in debt (over $100,000)

Creditors offered to take 50 cents on the dollar. He said no.

So he went on the road.

1880s Invests ~$300K

1894 Firm fails

1895 World tour

Later Paid in full

"Honor is a harder master than the law."

> Every creditor was paid in full.

YOUR TAKEAWAY

The rule he broke:

1. Genius in one field isn't skill in another

2. Cap any single bet at a set %

3. Never let one bet hold your future

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